

Speaking up

As teens get older, opportunities to speak up at school or college, on special occasions, and on behalf of important causes come up. Sharing thoughts and opinions in front of others can feel daunting, but these moments build confidence—and forge great memories, too.

SEE ALSO

◀ 18–19 Thinking independently

◀ 22–23 Self-expression

◀ 86–87 Confidence and self-esteem

◀ 90–91 Resilience

Big moments

Whether it is giving a speech at a club you belong to, accepting a prize for an achievement, or graduating from college, life is full of big moments for teens to present their best selves to the world.

▽ Different occasions

The occasion will determine the kind of speech and the approach the speaker should take.



△ When speaking to classmates, it's good to use a conversational tone.



△ Giving a speech in support of a cause at a rally requires clear ideas and a loud voice.



△ For debates, it's important to make notes and think quickly to persuade the audience.



△ Bringing objects and projects to show and explain can help when speaking in front of a club.



△ Wedding speeches typically include some jokes, but also personal stories about the couple.



△ People protesting tend to chant short, memorable lines that often rhyme.



△ Speaking at a group outing requires being clear about the plans and making instructions easy to understand.



△ When accepting a prize, speakers tend to be humble, humorous, and brief.



△ Graduation speeches are usually inspirational and reflect on the time spent in education.